Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

719
-7 -0.96%
Sep 4th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

830
-8.00 -0.95%
Sep 4th, 2024

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

629
-7 -1.10%
Sep 4th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

94.77
-1.99 -2.06%
Sep 4th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

100.88
-1.47 -1.44%
Sep 4th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

895
20 2.29%
Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2501 (sep) RMB/t (3pm close)

689.50
-14.00 -1.99%
Sep 4th, 2024 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
October 24 USD/dmt

92.75
-0.70 -0.75%
Sep 4th, 2024 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2501 (oct) RMB/t

3109
-40 -1.27%
Sep 4th, 2024 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

28.12
0.03 0.09%
Sep 3rd, 2024

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

11.77
-0.02 -0.17%
Sep 3rd, 2024

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3300
100 3.13%
Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

150.47
3.34 2.27%
Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

11.15
-0.73 -6.11%
Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3210
60 1.90%
Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Sep 4th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	719	-7.0	-0.96%	880	895	770	1063	93.42	-0.99	-1.1%	116.38	121.03	101.00	140.00
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	629	-7.0	-1.10%	785	781	665	963	82.15	-1.00	-1.2%	104.50	106.10	86.00	128.00
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	830	-8.0	-0.95%	996	1026	881	1175	108.43	-1.14	-1.0%	132.21	139.47	116.00	155.00

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Sep 4th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	94.77	-1.99	-2.06%	116.42	116.42	99.20	146.75
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	100.88	-1.47	-1.44%	130.60	130.60	115.45	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today, iron ore futures continued to decline, with the most-traded contract I2501 falling below 700 points, ultimately closing at 689.5, down 3.09% for the day. Traders showed a low willingness to sell. Steel mills were cautiously observing the market, mainly engaging in small and frequent purchases. Today's market transactions were sluggish. In Shandong, the transaction price of PB fines was around 690-695 yuan/mt, down 10-15 yuan/mt from yesterday; in Tangshan, the transaction price of PB fines was around 705-710 yuan/mt, also down 10-15 yuan/mt from yesterday. Last night, the ISM manufacturing PMI data released by the US fell short of market expectations, further raising concerns about the US manufacturing sector. Coupled with China's August PMI data released over the weekend, this led to a significant drop in ferrous metals series futures prices. From the perspective of iron ore fundamentals, the number of blast furnaces resuming production increased this week, with a slight rise in blast furnace operating rates and pig iron production. Although the pace of steel mills resuming production was slow, pig iron production is expected to increase significantly next week, which may provide some support for iron ore prices.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	895	20	2.3%	994	1041	900	1210	112.24	2.74	2.50%	126.95	136.27	113.28	153.57

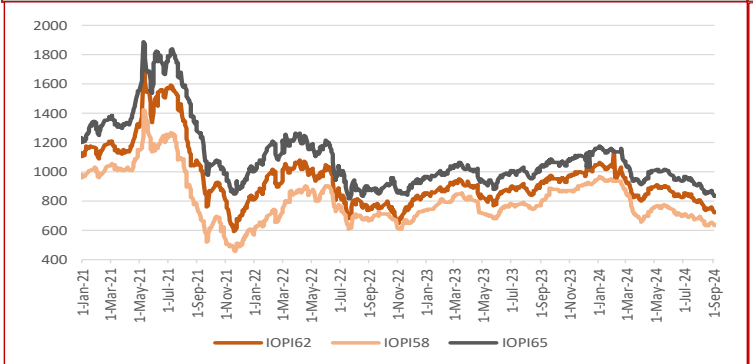
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	899	0.3%	779	1645	126.25	0.51%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1015	0.5%	780	1630	142.55	0.67%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	790	1.3%	620	1310	110.95	1.45%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	948	0.3%	800	1752	133.14	0.49%	0.00	272.32

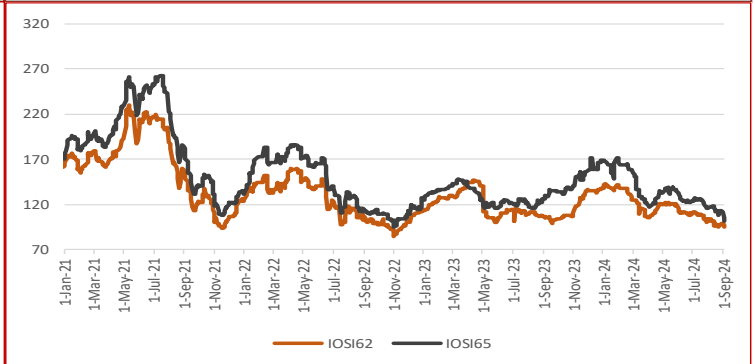
Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	889.73	0.38%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.87528

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 4th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	894	842	829	765	880	874	895	117.28	110.03	107.99	99.33	115.32	115.83	120.56
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	762	719	692	656	785	779	781	100.47	94.46	90.48	85.58	103.33	103.96	105.35
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1006	954	940	876	996	992	1026	132.42	125.13	123.05	114.39	131.20	131.91	139.19

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 4th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	120.10	110.42	107.58	99.33	112.14	115.18	116.42
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	136.06	125.14	123.01	114.06	122.86	129.04	130.60

FREIGHT RATES

Sep 3rd, 2024		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	11.77	-0.02	-0.17%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	28.12	0.03	0.09%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1024	1011	1001	911	933	989	1017	129.18	127.27	125.75	114.10	119.96	126.47	134.98

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Sep 4th, 2024		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-90	-12.52%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	111	15.44%

Sep 4th, 2024		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	6.11	6.45%

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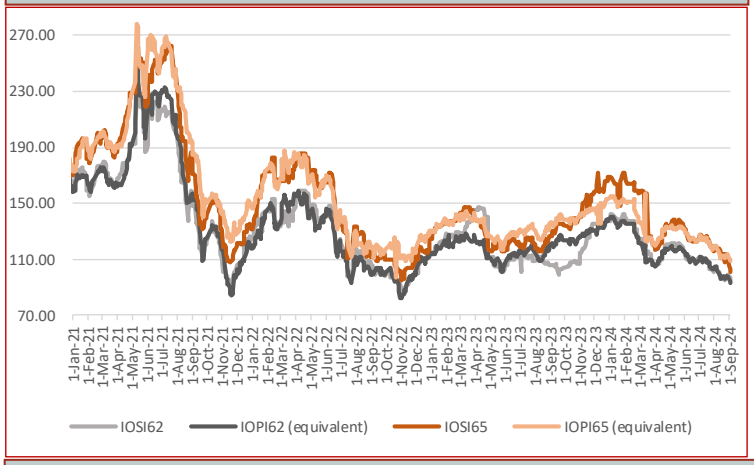
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Sep 4th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	662	-7	-57
SIMEC Fines	588	-7	-131
PB Fines	689	-7	-30
Newman Fines	687	-7	-32
MAC Fines	668	-7	-51
Jimblebar Blended Fines	583	-7	-136
Carajas Fines	899	-7	180
Brazilian SSF	680	-7	-39
Brazilian Blend Fines	702	-7	-17
RTX Fines	601	-7	-118
West Pilbara Fines	631	-7	-88

Sep 4th, 2024	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	90.27	-1.99	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	86.77	-1.99	-8.00
PB Fines	91.02	-1.99	-3.75
Newman Fines	93.90	-1.99	-0.88
MAC Fines	91.02	-1.99	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	83.40	-1.99	-11.38
Carajas Fines	124.32	-1.99	29.55
Brazilian SSF	98.52	-1.99	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	100.15	-1.99	5.38
RTX Fines	84.65	-1.99	-10.13
West Pilbara Fines	89.02	-1.99	-5.75

Sep 4th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	629	-7	0
FMG Blended Fines	637	-7	8
Robe River	637	-7	8
Western Fines	640	-7	11
Atlas Fines	635	-7	6
Yandi	623	-7	-6

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	12.00	-3.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	23.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	23.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	23.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	15.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	48.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	40.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	16.00	-7.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	29.00	-3.00
	Low Fe Grade	11.00	3.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	0.75	-0.50
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.25	0.75
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.25	0.75
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.25	0.75
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	0.25	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	0.25	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	0.25	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-50.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-15.00	0.00	Jingtang	-15.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-20.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-10.00	0.00

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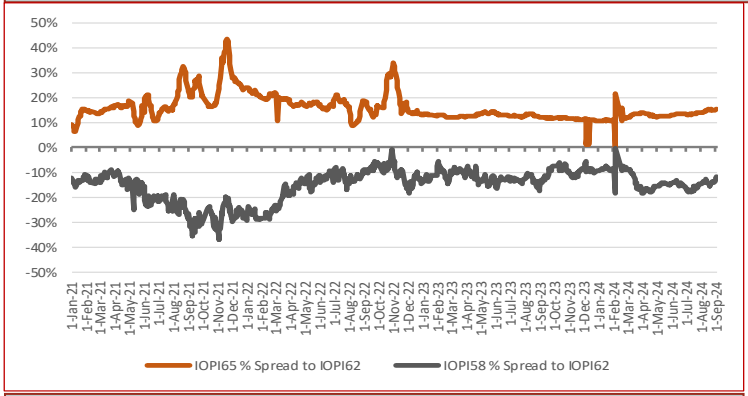
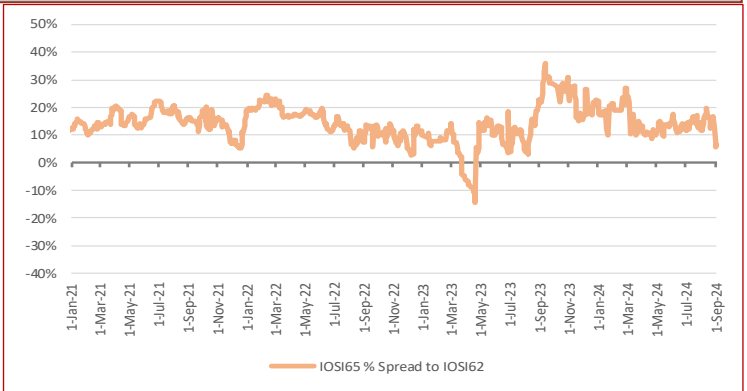
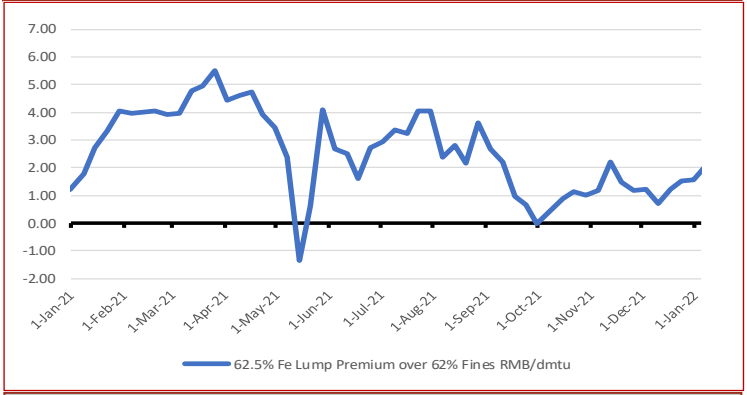
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

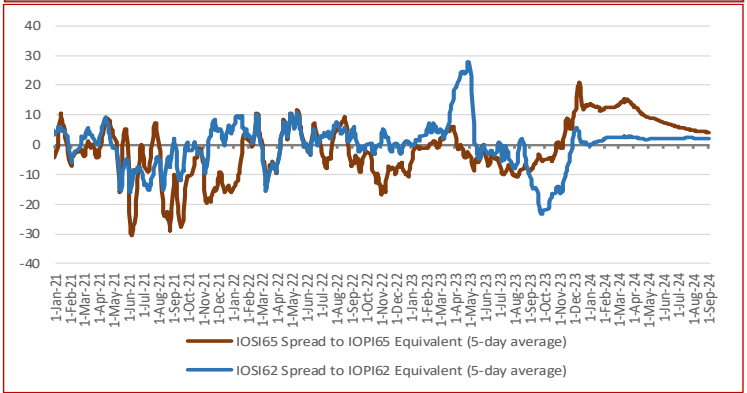




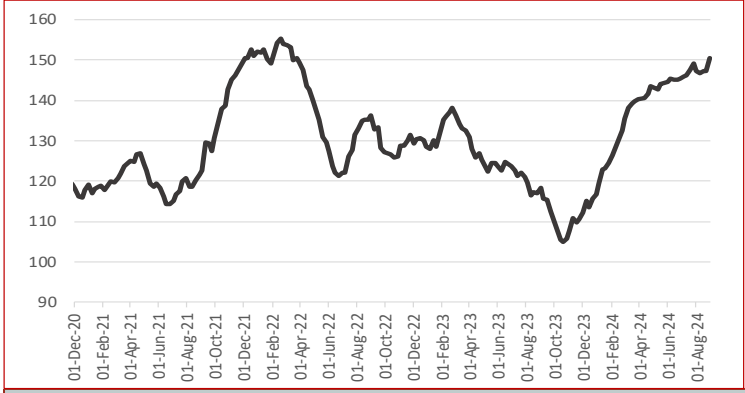
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



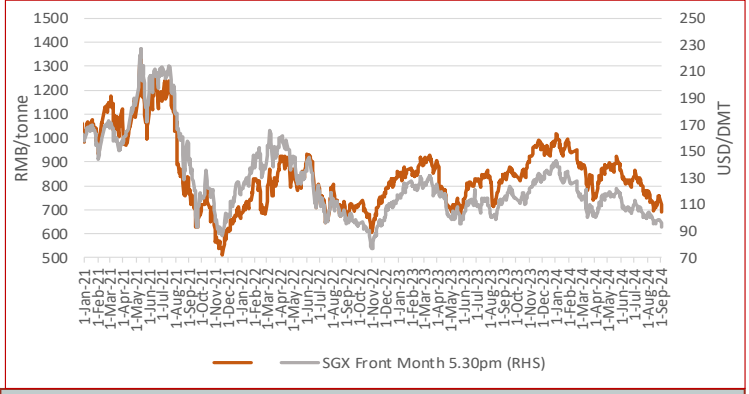
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

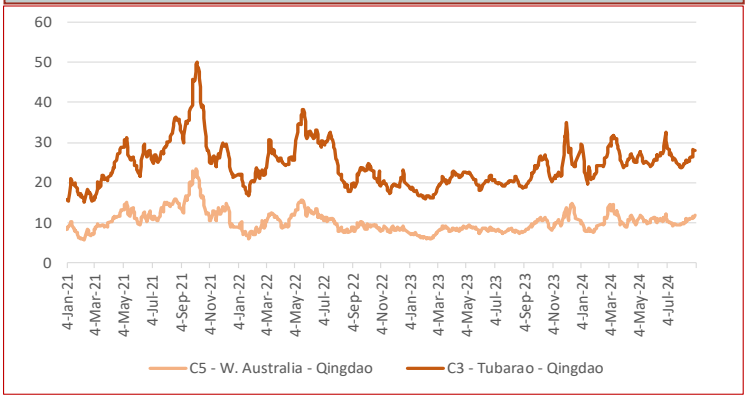
Week Ending Aug 30th, 2024

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	15.25	1.06%	8.41	19.20
Qingdao	24.55	6.28%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	17.96	2.98%	7.56	17.96
Tianjin	11.86	3.40%	6.49	12.97
Rizhao	20.54	1.03%	9.44	20.54
Total (35 Ports)	150.47	2.27%	98.80	155.39

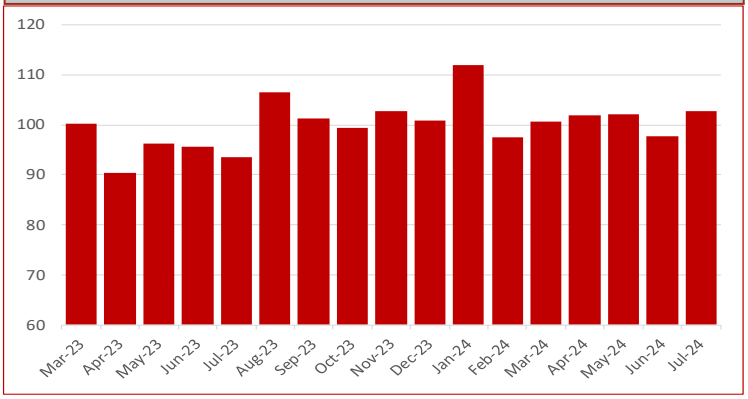
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Sep 4th, 3pm close			Sep 4th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2501	Change	Change %	October. 24	Change	Change %
Closing Price	689.50	-14.00	-1.99%	92.75	-0.70	-0.75%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	61.31	8.33	15.72%	11.89	2.75	30.11%
Open positions ('000 lots)	55.02	1.34	2.49%	41.10	1.24	3.10%
Day Low	688.5	-11.50	-1.64%	91.75	-1.70	-1.82%
Day High	706.5	-18.50	-2.55%	94.85	-2.40	-2.47%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2024/8/30	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,300	100	3.13%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,550	80	2.31%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,210	60	1.90%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,760	0	0.00%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,290	70	2.17%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	3,920	-10	-0.25%
Colour Coated Plate	6,100	-50	-0.81%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

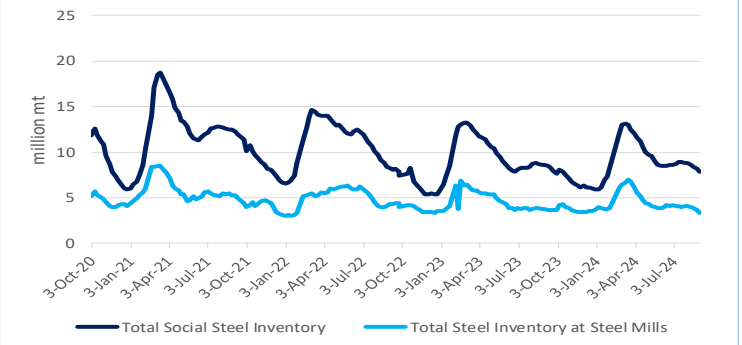
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	94.90	0	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,845	-55	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,390	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,598	7	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,162	8	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	58	102	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,233	3	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	-33	77	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

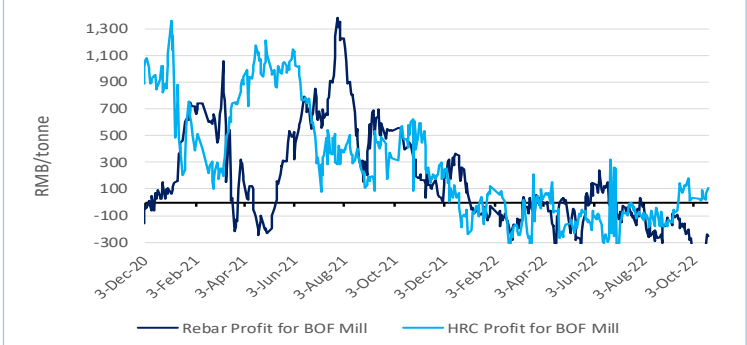
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

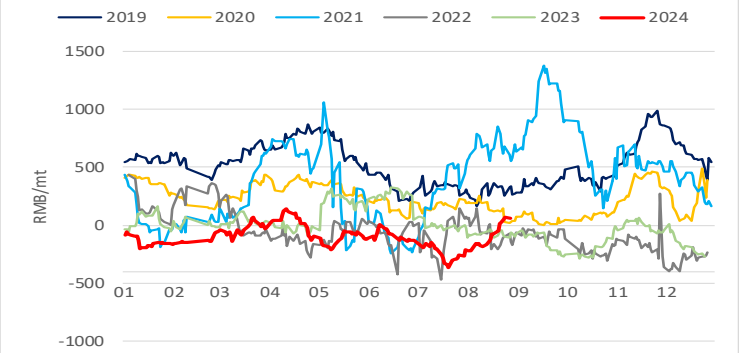
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



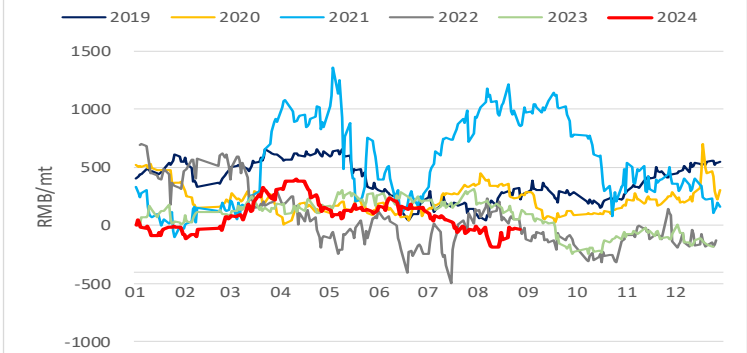
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



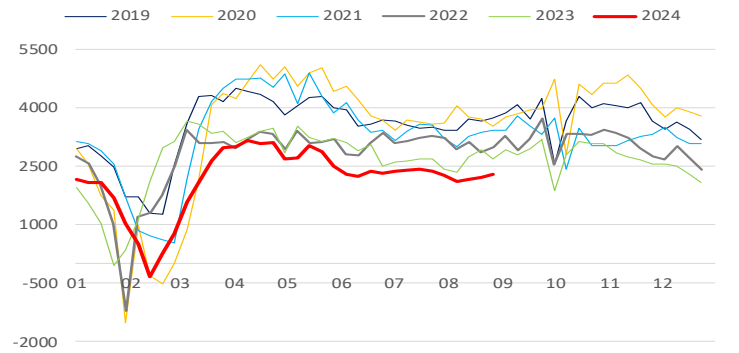
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



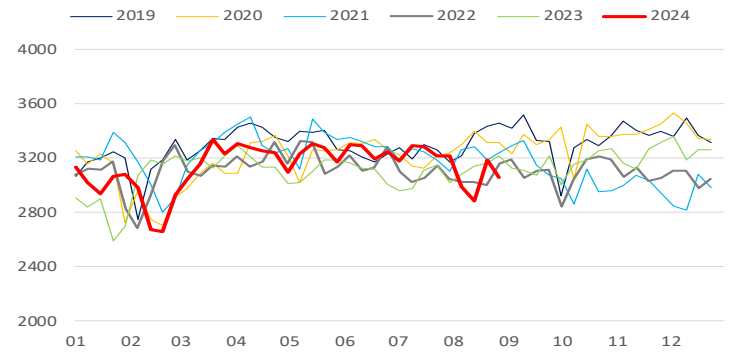
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



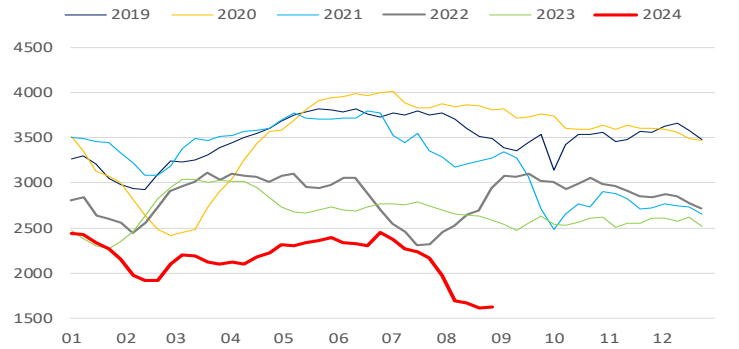
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



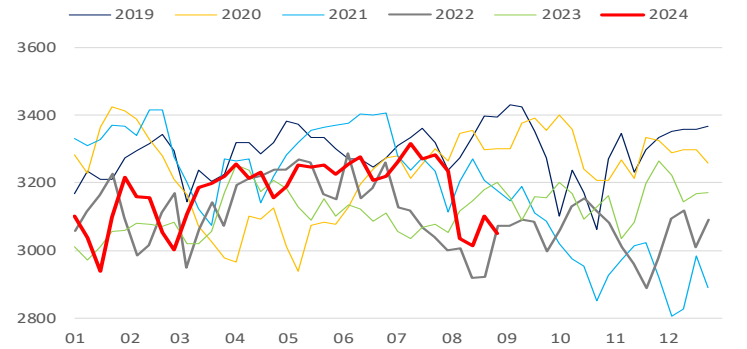
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Sep 4th, 2024	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Sep 4th, 2024	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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